

When I was in elementary school, my teacher gave us a problem that used concepts I wouldn't learn until middle school. I couldn't solve it although I tried very hard and flipped through notes for clues and answers. But in the end, I still failed. That feeling stayed with me, not the frustration of losing, but the curiosity of understanding the problem and the solution. At that moment, I knew what I wanted to study for years to come.

My teacher also wrote an equation on the board that I still don't fully understand today: $e^{(i\pi)} + 1 = 0$. It looked so mystical and magical, especially to me when I was only in elementary school. That's the reason why I'm so passionate about Mathematics. The satisfaction and sense of accomplishment after solving a complex problem makes me feel genuine satisfaction. I decided to major in applied mathematics because it solves real problems. One perk of being a math major is the opportunities it offers. At UC Berkeley, I plan to engage with the mathematics program and deal with the complex problems, especially the ones that help others. While I have yet to declare a minor, I want to emphasize on my love for quantitative courses by minoring in computer science. And since California and the Berkeley campus itself are a multicultural hub, I can fit in the cultural aspects of the school while accessing the best resources it has to offer.